

Dear Rithik and Saharsha,

I'm applying for the Forward Deployed Engineer seat on the civilian agency team. Two things make this worth both of our time: I have already found government fraud with ML, and I have already run the forward-deployed motion for a regulated client serving 200K people.

The fraud work first. For the **City of Rochester** (a Simon Vision Consulting engagement), I built an explainable fraud-screening model for a city loan program: **XGBoost with SHAP attribution**, accuracy lifted from **62% to 73%**. The part that matters for Lexor is not the accuracy number. It's that every flag came with reason codes a loan officer could defend in review. Your thesis, that auditors act on evidence chains rather than scores, is the exact lesson that project taught me.

The forward-deployed work is my day job. As the first AI hire at ESC Partners, I architected and shipped **Maya AI** in **2.5 months**: a production agent on Oracle CCS that classifies intent across voice, chat, SMS, email, and mobile, then executes billing, payment plan, and outage transactions through tool calls. It handles **70 to 80%** of first-touch volume at a **200K-resident utility**. I sat with the client's supervisors before writing code, and the thing that won them over was the human-in-the-loop design: low-confidence drafts arrive as Teams approval cards, and a live console hands control to a human in one click. I also built **VaultIQ**, an air-gapped Claude Opus platform that runs entirely inside the customer VPC, which is the closest habit I have to working with government-restricted data sources.

On your Tier 1 profile: before AI, I bootstrapped two companies across the UK and MENA and sold both for **\$575K combined**, with **95%** client retention after acquisition. I know what it means to be the person the partner calls, and I like that weight.

The honest constraint, so we can deal with it in the first ten minutes: I am not a US citizen. I'm work-authorized in the US today on F-1 STEM OPT, H-1B eligible, and open to the O-1 path you've flagged for the civilian team. I understand the top-secret team is off the table. I'm ready to relocate to DC as soon as needed and 5 days in person is how I prefer to work anyway.

If the visa math works for Team 2, I think you'll find the profile fit is real. Happy to walk through Maya AI's architecture end to end on a whiteboard.

Best,

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